

THEFAB COOKBOOK - VOLUME I

Boeuf Wellington with Creamed Spinach and Foie Gras

A special-occasion centrepiece: tender beef, mushroom duxelles, a discreet layer of foie gras and crisp pastry, balanced by silky creamed spinach on the side.

Serves 6	Prep 1 h	Cook 35-45 min	Rest 20 min
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TheFAB studio note

Everything must be cold before the pastry stage, and the mushroom duxelles must be dry. Moisture is the enemy of a crisp Wellington.

Ingredients

- 1 kg centre-cut beef tenderloin / fillet
- 500 g mushrooms, very finely chopped
- 2 shallots, finely chopped
- 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 80-120 g foie gras, sliced thinly or gently spreadable
- 8-10 slices prosciutto or Parma ham
- 500 g all-butter puff pastry
- 2 egg yolks beaten with 1 tbsp milk
- Dijon mustard, for brushing
- Thyme, salt, pepper, olive oil and butter
- For the spinach: 800 g fresh spinach, 1 shallot, 1 garlic clove, 200 ml cream, nutmeg, salt, pepper

Method

- 1 Season the beef, sear it quickly on all sides in a hot pan, then cool completely. Brush lightly with Dijon mustard.
- 2 Cook shallots, garlic and mushrooms in butter until the duxelles is very dry. Season with thyme, salt and pepper. Cool fully.
- 3 Lay cling film on the counter. Arrange prosciutto into a rectangle, spread over the duxelles, then add a thin, even layer of foie gras.
- 4 Place the beef on top and roll tightly into a cylinder. Chill for 20 to 30 minutes so it keeps its shape.
- 5 Wrap the chilled beef in puff pastry, seal underneath, decorate if desired, and brush with egg wash. Chill again for 15 minutes.
- 6 Bake at 200°C until the pastry is golden and the beef reaches about 48-50°C for rare or 52-54°C for medium-rare before resting. Rest 15 to 20 minutes.
- 7 For the creamed spinach, wilt the spinach, squeeze out water, then cook with shallot, garlic, cream and a little nutmeg until silky. Serve alongside thick slices of Wellington.

Proposed wine pairing

A pairing designed to support the main character of the dish rather than overpower it.

Best match	A mature Left Bank Bordeaux - Pauillac, Saint-Julien or Saint-Estephe - with softened tannins.
Also works	Pomerol or Saint-Emilion for a rounder Merlot profile; mature Rioja Gran Reserva; Northern Rhone Syrah if you want pepper and savoury depth.
Why it works	Beef, mushrooms, pastry and foie gras need structure, age and savoury complexity. Mature tannins are better than aggressive young power.
Serving note	For a very festive service, offer a small glass of Sauternes with the foie gras element before moving to the red with the Wellington.

Personal adjustment: choose a bottle you would happily drink even without the dish. Pairing should amplify pleasure, not become an exam.